SPECIAL RELEASE

Highlights of the 2024 Census of Population: Virac

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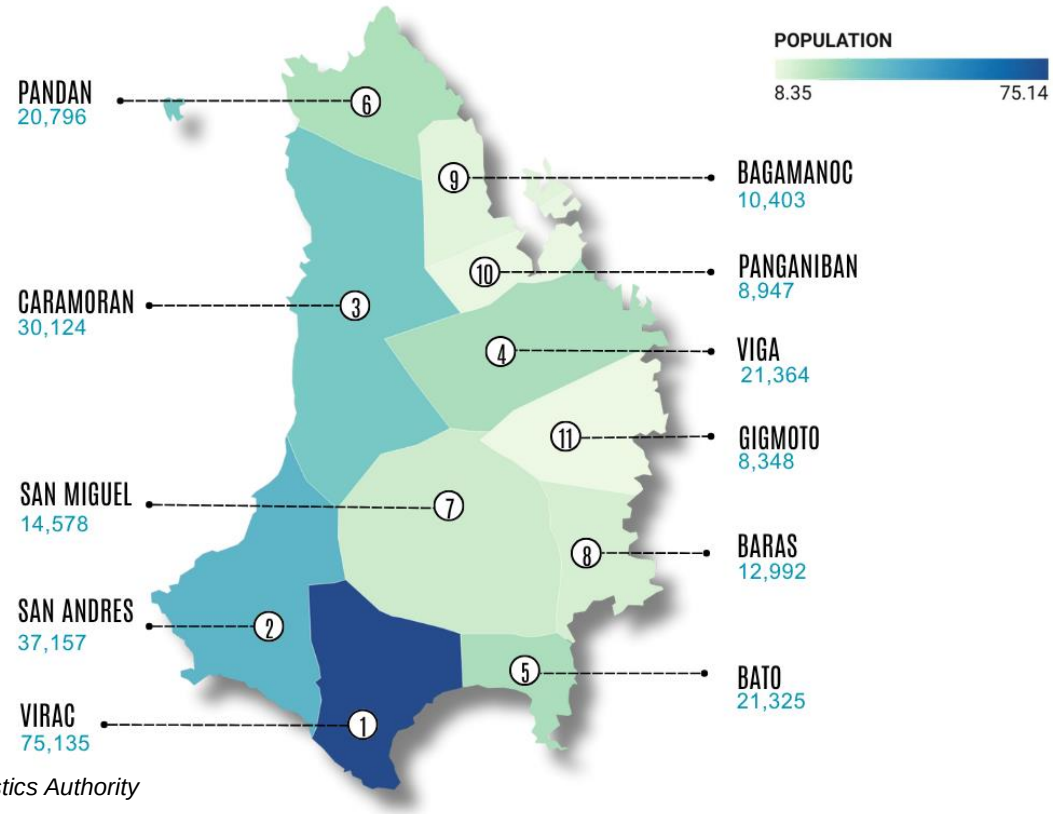
Population of Virac as of 01 July 2024 is 75,135

The Philippine Statistics Authority – Catanduanes has released the official results of the 2024 Census of Population (POPCEN), providing a detailed overview of the latest demographic landscape across the province. As of 01 July 2024, the municipality of Virac registered a total population 75,135, representing 28.8 percent of the entire province's population of 261,169. (Figure 1)

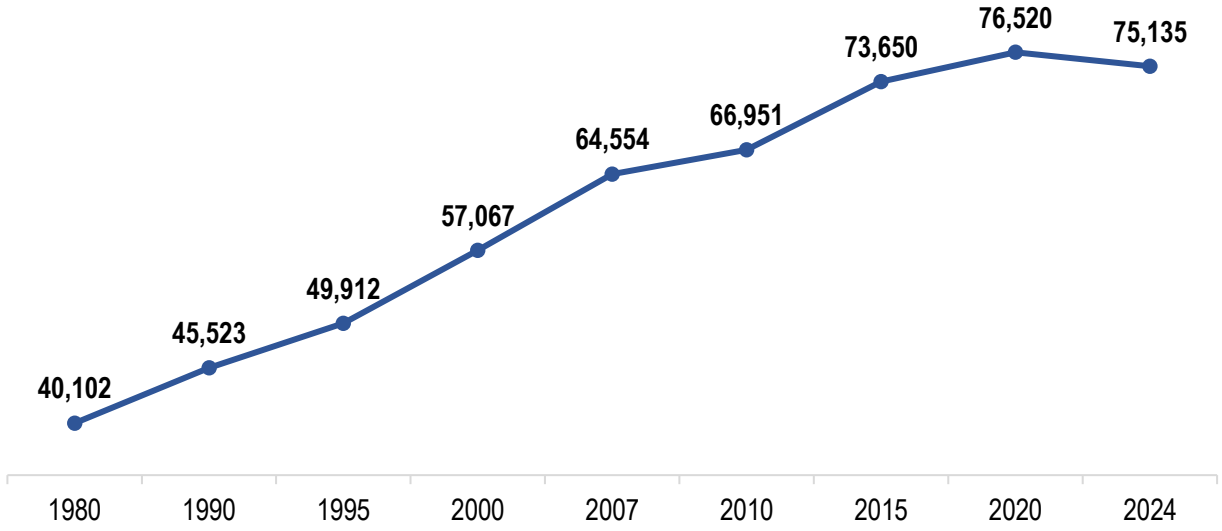
Compared to the population count in 2020, which was 76,520, the municipality experienced a decrease of 1,385 persons. This translates to a negative annual Population Growth Rate (PGR) of -0.44 percent. This means that the Virac's population declined by an average of 44 persons per 10,000 population per year from 2020 to 2024. (Figure 2 and Table 1)

Figure 1. Catanduanes Population by Municipality: 01 July 2024, 12:01AM



Source: Philippine Statistics Authority

Figure 2. Population of Virac based on Various Census Years: 1990-2024



Source: Philippine Statistics Authority

Table 1. Annual Population Growth Rate of Virac: 2010-2024

Intercensal Period	Population Growth Rate (%)
2010-2015	1.83
2015-2020	0.81
2020-2024	-0.44

Source: Philippine Statistics Authority

Among the 63 barangays in Virac, population changes varied, with some areas showing decreases while others posted moderate to substantial increases. Valencia had the highest population increase, rising by 261 residents, followed by Santo Domingo with 133 residents, Sogod-Tibgao with 132 residents, and Tubaon with 127 residents.

In contrast, Rawis recorded the largest decline with 318 fewer residents. Other barangays with declines included San Roque with 195, Santa Cruz with 187, Constantino with 173, Magnesia Del Norte with 169, and Dugui San Vicente with 169. Decreases were also noted in San Juan, Santa Elena, Salvacion, and Calatagan Proper.

Barangays such as Calampong, Palnab Del Norte, and Santo Cristo posted small population gains, while others like Buyo, Bigaa, and Pajo San Isidro experienced moderate decline.

Table 2. Total Population of Virac by Barangay: 2020 and 2024

Municipality/Barangay	01 May 2020	01 July 2020	Increment/Decrement (2020-2024)
VIRAC	**76,520**	**75,135**	*-1,385*
Antipolo Del Norte	731	713	*-18*
Antipolo Del Sur	621	598	*-23*
Balite	939	900	*-39*
Batag	503	523	*20*
Bigaa	3,383	3,287	*-96*
Buenavista	440	490	*50*
Buyo	1,782	1,700	*-82*
Cabihian	512	502	*-10*
Calabnigan	770	783	*13*
Calampong	327	356	*29*
Calatagan Proper	3,335	3,205	*-130*
Calatagan Tibang	2,498	2,539	*41*
Capilihan	1,529	1,576	*47*
Casoocan	549	595	*46*
Cavinitan	3,959	3,900	*-59*
Gogon Sirangan	808	798	*-10*
Concepcion	929	797	*-132*
Constantino	811	638	*-173*
Danicop	2,241	2,366	*125*
Dugui San Vicente	654	485	*-169*
Dugui San Isidro	403	364	*-39*
Dugui Too	1,474	1,400	*-74*
F. Tacorda Village	411	386	*-25*
Francia	1,801	1,894	*93*
Gogon Centro	2,177	2,116	*-61*
Hawan Grande	894	849	*-45*
Hawan Ilaya	676	793	*117*
Hicming	1,151	1,205	*54*
Igang	848	832	*-16*
Juan M. Alberto	498	539	*41*
Lanao	1,008	976	*-32*
Magnesia Del Norte	770	601	*-169*
Magnesia Del Sur	865	767	*-98*
Marcelo Alberto	811	797	*-14*
Marilima	356	408	*52*
Pajo Baguio	540	554	*14*
Pajo San Isidro	1,205	1,133	*-72*
Palnab Del Norte	1,998	2,030	*32*
Palnab Del Sur	1,970	1,976	*6*

Source: Philippine Statistics Authority

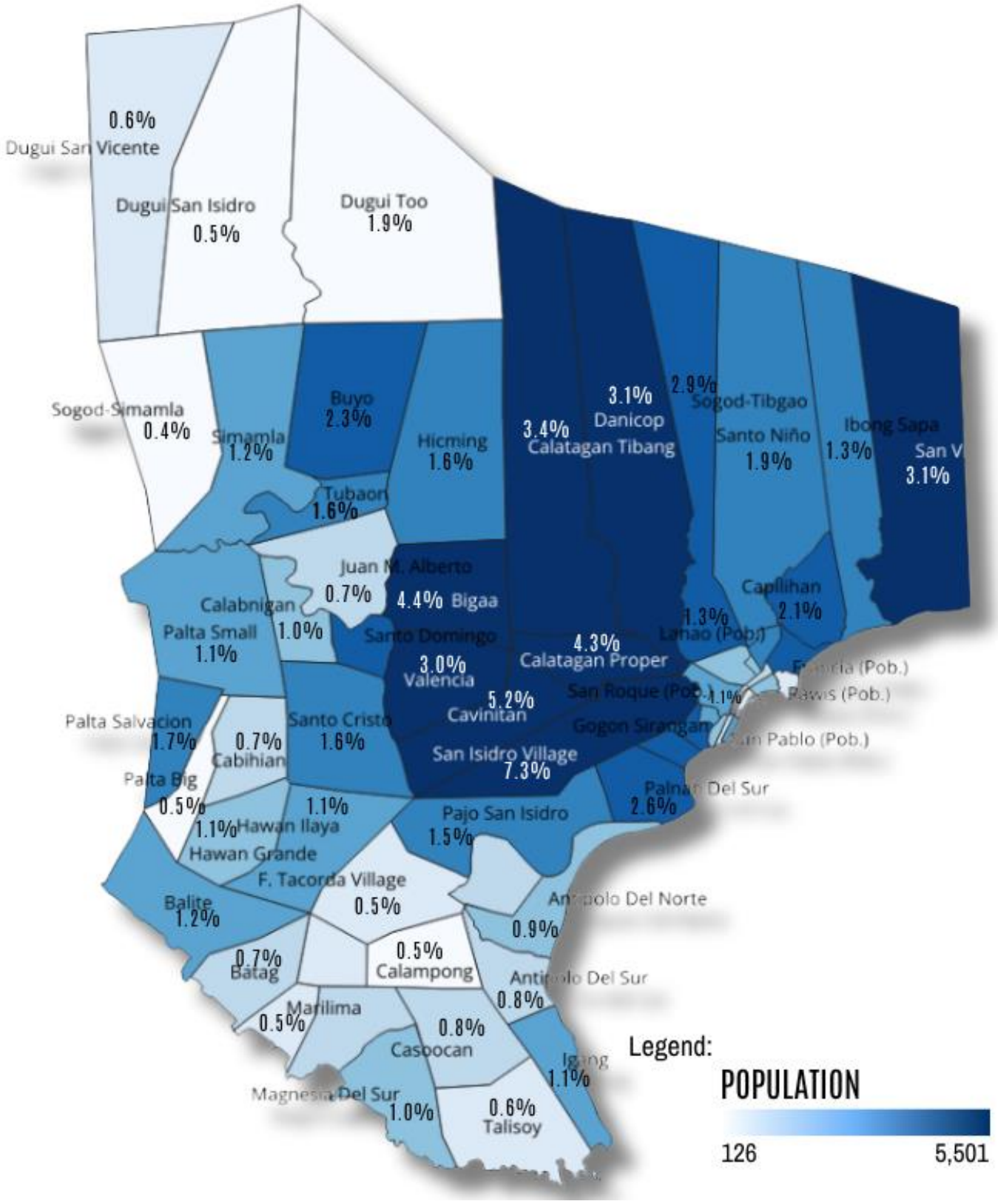
Table 2. Total Population of Virac by Barangay: 2020 and 2024_*continuation*

Municipality/Barangay	01 May 2020	01 July 2020	Increment/Decrement (2020-2024)
VIRAC	**76,520**	**75,135**	*-1,385*
Palta Big	387	361	*-26*
Palta Salvacion	1,234	1,299	*65*
Palta Small	948	861	*-87*
Rawis	2,018	1,700	*-318*
Salvacion	495	391	*-104*
San Isidro Village	5,459	5,501	*42*
San Jose	107	126	*19*
San Juan	599	476	*-123*
San Pablo	870	830	*-40*
San Pedro	264	219	*-45*
San Roque	997	802	*-195*
San Vicente	2,276	2,300	*24*
Ibong Sapa	935	970	*35*
Santa Cruz	974	787	*-187*
Santa Elena	713	572	*-141*
Santo Cristo	1,209	1,233	*24*
Santo Domingo	1,434	1,567	*133*
Santo Niño	1,459	1,422	*-37*
Simamla	922	893	*-29*
Sogod-Simamla	359	336	*-23*
Talisoy	572	486	*-86*
Sogod-Tibgao	2,031	2,163	*132*
Tubaon	1,099	1,226	*127*
Valencia	1,982	2,243	*261*

Source: Philippine Statistics Authority

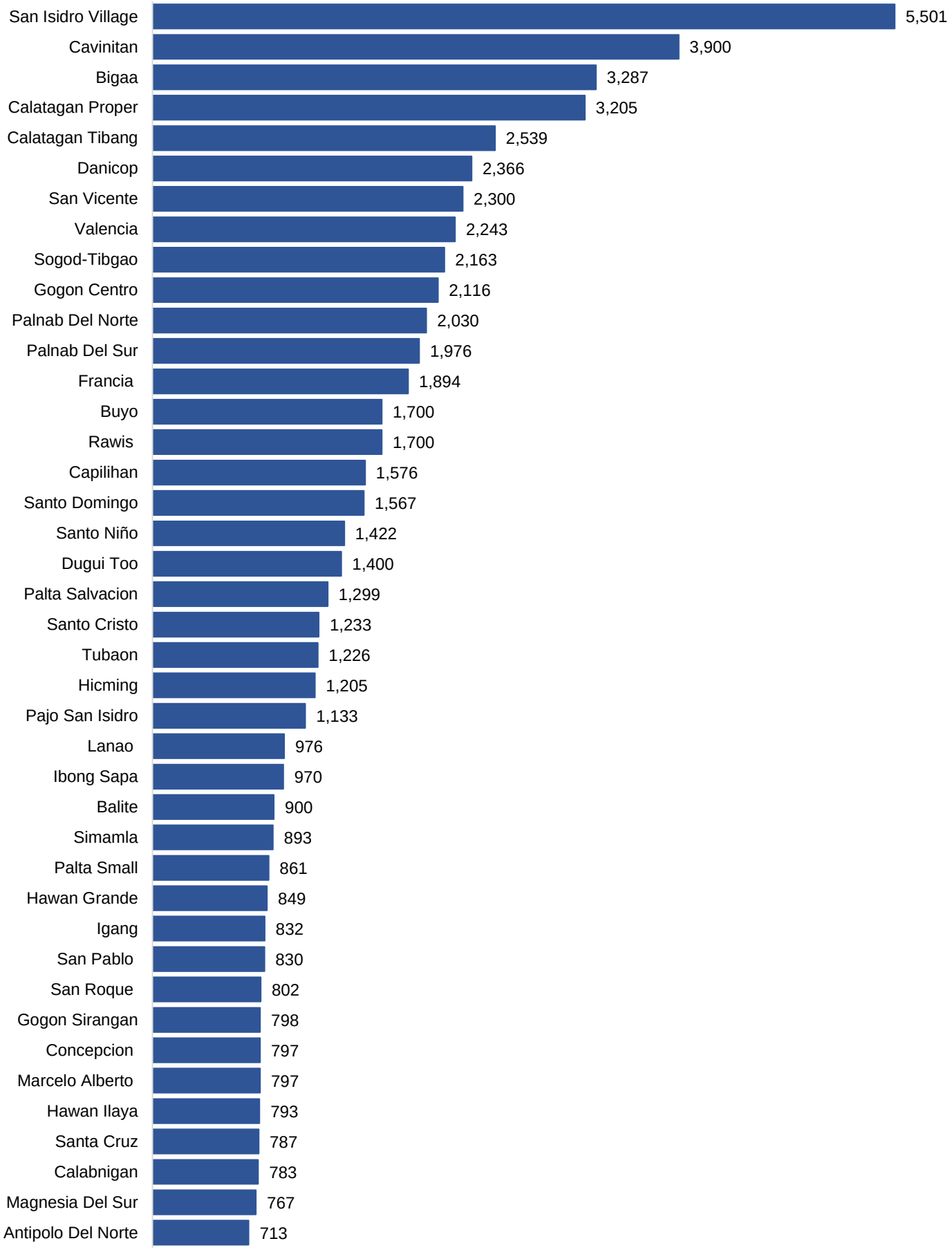
San Isidro Village holds the largest population in the entire province with 5,501 residents, and representing 7.3 percent of Virac's total population. It is followed by Cavinitan with 3,900 and Bigaa with 3,287, ranking second and third respectively in the provincial count. Other highly populated barangays include Calatagan Proper (3,205) and Calatagan Tibang (2,539), ranking fifth and tenth in the province. Several other barangays such as Danicop, San Vicente, Valencia, Sogod-Tibgao, Gogon Centro, and Palnab Del Norte have populations ranging from 2,000 to 2,400. Mid-tier barangays like Francia, Rawis, Buyo, Capilihan, and Santo Domingo have populations between 1,500 to 1,900, showing stable settlement patterns. On the lower end, barangays such as San Pedro and San Jose report very low populations, with only 219 and 126 residents respectively.

Figure 3. Thematic map of Virac by Share of Population: 2024



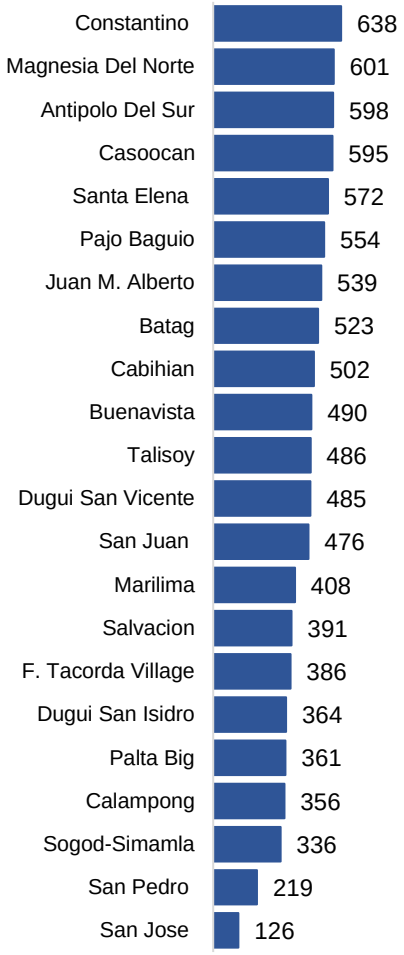
Source: Philippine Statistics Authority

Figure 4. Population Distribution of Virac: 01 July 2024



Source: Philippine Statistics Authority

Figure 4. Population Distribution of Virac: 01 July 2024_ *continuation*



Source: Philippine Statistics Authority

TECHNICAL NOTES

- ***Reference Period –*** the specific date and time that the census data refers to. For the 2024 POPCEN, this is 12:01 a.m. of July 1, 2024, meaning all population data collected pertains to the status as of that exact moment.
- ***Population Growth Rate –*** The rate at which the population is increasing (or decreasing) in a given period due to natural increase and net migration, expressed as a percentage of the base population.
- ***Total Population -*** the sum of the household population and institutional population. It also includes Filipinos in Philippine embassies, consulates, and missions abroad

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